

7, The Chinese Rulers Have Mastered the Essentials of Lying

The title of this subsection seems highly contradictory to the one before the last. If the Chinese rulers have truly mastered the essentials of lying, then why are the lies they fabricate so clumsy?

Such a seemingly contradictory set of facts precisely reflects how "lying" should be conducted as a political behavior.

Apart from omission, using evasive language, and mixing falsehoods with truths—which are common methods of lying—a critical point we must pay special attention to is the distinction between group psychology and individual psychology.

Therefore, the Nazi Minister of Propaganda, Joseph Goebbels, heavily emphasized one point: **if a government is to lie, it must tell a colossal lie (the "Big Lie" / 弥天大谎) rather than a small one.**

For an individual, a bizarrely outrageous lie paradoxically makes them feel it is "unlikely to be false." People tend to believe that no one would be audacious enough to fabricate such an absurd lie.

It is much like Emperor Gaozu of Han, Liu Bang. Clearly penniless, he dared to declare a gift of "ten thousand strings of cash" (贺钱万) at a banquet; the sum was simply so massive that people subconsciously refused to believe anyone would dare make such a joke.

Once the government applies this technique to society, the effect of the lie is magnified.

The rulers broadcast the lie through authoritative figures or institutions, which initially deceives a small batch of blind believers in the absence of evidence. Because they subconsciously recognize that the lie is outrageous, once people believe it, they tend to seek information that supports the lie while ignoring or denying contradictory information—this is what is commonly known as **"confirmation bias"** (确认偏误).

After completing this reinforcement of their own beliefs, those who believe the lie will attempt to persuade the people around them, in order to alleviate the anxiety brought about by their own subconscious doubts. Once many people believe a certain lie, an individual might choose to believe it under social pressure, even if they still harbor doubts internally.

After publicly stating their belief in a certain lie, out of consideration for maintaining their self-image—what the Chinese commonly refer to as **"face"** (面子 / *Mianzi*)—people are unwilling to admit they were deceived, even if they later learn the truth.

The famous piece *The Emperor's New Clothes* written by the Danish fairy-tale author Hans Christian Andersen is exactly about this phenomenon. Everyone felt that a supreme, infinitely glorious king could not possibly be so stupid as to not realize he was wearing no clothes; therefore, everyone vied to praise the beauty of a garment that simply did not exist.

Yet, the one who finally punctured this lie was a child, because a child cares nothing for "face"; he had not yet reached the age of possessing the self-awareness of *Mianzi*.

China's history directly proves the greatness of Mr. Andersen using a realistic, incredibly prolonged, and widespread example. The fact is, such a fairy tale can absolutely happen in reality, and the

civilization involved accounted for roughly one-fourth of the world's population and total economic output throughout historical periods.

How did the Chinese Empire manage to persistently deceive its own subjects and foreign observers for so long? It is nothing more than its history being too ancient and its mass being too colossal. With a bit of dressing up, if we were to tell a foreigner without any explanation: "*This so-called Celestial Empire (天朝上国) has actually long been a walking corpse (行尸走肉),*" that foreigner would also find it extremely difficult to believe.

Whenever the viewpoints held by Chinese officialdom and its ideology are overly bizarre, people paradoxically start wondering if they might actually be true. *Would a country that appears so powerful and has enjoyed such historical prestige really engage in such deception?* This mentality is exactly the same as the psychology of the king's subjects viewing the naked king in *The Emperor's New Clothes*.

If one were to tell an ordinary lie instead of a colossal one, the probability of being seen through might actually be higher. Because it is almost impossible to avoid lying over the course of a human life, the vast majority of people are very familiar with small lies, and possess excellent intuition regarding things they understand relatively well.

Goebbels's so-called "telling a Big Lie" is, to a certain extent, meant to preemptively overwhelm and destroy the rational thinking of the populace.

The second trick to lying lies in never attempting to cover up or justify the lie, especially when lying to the entire society.

Any lie, regardless of its magnitude or malignancy, is inherently a narrative contrary to reality. Speaking from an abstract perspective, according to the principles of physics, the complete information of a system—even after undergoing complex transformations—still exists in some form within the universe. Therefore, a lie can never be perfectly covered up. Masking a lie requires even more lies, which inevitably leads to an ever-increasing number of flaws.

Simultaneously, if the liar is already contemplating how to cover their tracks while telling the lie, it becomes exceedingly difficult for them to overwhelm the audience with sheer momentum and audacity.

The Book of Lord Shang (《商君书》) astutely pointed this out two thousand years ago: the court has no business acting like a thief for a thousand days. The ruler must not be a stealthy thief or swindler who steals the state; rather, he must directly become a thug (暴徒). What he needs to do is not politely deceive the people to gain their trust, but **directly violate the minds of the people; he must not merely coax the people into his trap, but directly hijack them onto his doomed pirate ship (绑架到贼船上).**

Thus, when lying, one must never consider the consequences. What the ruler should do is ensure the lie is massive enough to sustain a single, colossal execution of evil deeds, rather than worrying about how to continue the deception afterward. As long as a single, decisive deception achieves his political objectives, it is sufficient to render those who were duped entirely incapable of backing out, regardless of their reasons.

Nazi Germany and the Japanese Empire during World War II serve as excellent examples. Up until the Allied forces breached the German homeland, the Nazi regime was still executing deserters via

military tribunals. Even days before suffering the atomic bombings, the Japanese were still preparing for the "*Glorious Shattering of the Hundred Million*" (一亿玉碎 / *Ichoku Gyokusai*).

How could the over one hundred million commoners of Germany and Japan all be fools? No matter how many enemy personnel and equipment the battle reports claimed to have annihilated, could they possibly be oblivious when the flames of war burned their own homeland? Could the bombs raining from the sky be fake?

But by this point, even if the German and Japanese commoners knew they had been duped, there was absolutely nothing they could do.

This is exactly the objective rulers aim for when committing atrocities. Initially, when the people discovered they were deceived by the government, they might have refused to admit it merely out of social pressure and concern for their own "face" (脸面). By the time they were completely unable to deceive themselves any longer, they discovered they could no longer jump ship. **Now, the entire state and nation had to be buried alongside the ruler and the evil system he relied upon.**

Thus, the reader should be able to roughly understand why I stated *both* that the Chinese rulers have mastered the essentials of lying, and that their lies are often extremely clumsy. Far from being contradictory, this is entirely logical.

It is precisely because the Chinese rulers have, historically, almost completely deceived both domestic and foreign people and scholars through an astonishing distortion of historical narratives, that they can *now* maintain their rule using merely low-cost, exceptionally clumsy lies. This is a profoundly sorrowful reality.

If the reader still finds this difficult to believe, they need only continue reading. By the time they finish reviewing the entirety of this manuscript, clarity will naturally dawn upon their minds.

At the very end of this subsection, I must also point out that although the **restoration-bureaucratic state** is sometimes exceedingly clumsy in fabricating historical lies, it is indeed highly adept at "civilizing and indoctrinating" (教化) the populace.

If readers pay attention to Chinese social public opinion, they will know that in recent years, a "Hanfu fever" (汉服热 / the craze for traditional Han Chinese clothing) has swept across various regions of China. This has concurrently driven a surge in popularity for traditional Han Chinese weddings, characterized primarily by traditional Han attire.

Readers will immediately realize that in the late stages of the **restoration-bureaucratic state**, weddings—as a crucial life ceremony—had already become a vital occasion for instilling the ideology of the restoration-bureaucratic society.

For example, among all major civilizations worldwide, only the Chinese refer to the groom as "*Xin Lang Guan*" (新郎官 / bridegroom-official). Foreigners find it almost impossible to imagine: *a wedding is just a wedding; what on earth does it have to do with becoming an official?*

However, in a place where the bureaucratic system utterly determines the allocation of power and social resources, getting promoted to an official rank is practically the highest blessing one can bestow—otherwise, one would have to wish someone to become the emperor, which is an utterance of "heinous treason" (大逆不道).

Traditional Han wedding attire fully reflects this ideology. Up until the Ming Dynasty, provided they had the means, the groom would wear official robes (官服) as his wedding attire, while the bride was permitted to use the ceremonial dress of a titled noblewoman (诰命 / *Gaoming*).

However, it is glaringly obvious that traditional Han wedding attire was not like this in the beginning. The evolution of wedding attire precisely mirrors the progression of China's historical trajectory.

In classical China during the Qin and Han periods, issues such as how wedding garments and the couple's hairstyles should be handled merely served to indicate one point: that both spouses had reached adulthood and were fully capable of shouldering the responsibility of starting a family.

During the Eastern Han Dynasty, because the bureaucratic system had already become highly formidable, the Eastern Han Confucian scholar Zheng Xuan (郑玄), when annotating the *Book of Rites* (《仪礼》), first proposed the concept of "**Shesheng**" (摄盛 / ritual usurpation or temporary elevation of status). This meant that the bride and groom could adopt ceremonial systems slightly "overstepping" (僭越) their status during the wedding. Yet, the ceremonial systems reflected here were precisely the bureaucratic hierarchies.

When Eastern Han Confucianism attempted to "unify the Three Orthodoxies" (通三统), they habitually employed a specific trick: equating the aristocratic hierarchical system of the **early states** in the pre-Qin era with the bureaucratic hierarchical system post-mid-Western Han, thereby substituting concepts on the sly. Eastern Han Confucian scholars naturally knew exactly how vastly different pre-Qin society was from the era they currently inhabited, but the increasingly dominant role of the bureaucratic system over society made this adaptive "re-interpretation movement" inevitable.

Between the 3rd and 6th centuries AD—the period with the highest degree of **feudalization** in China—"Shesheng" was suppressed. This carried a certain inevitability. Although the landlord class did not successfully transform into **feudal lords**, a strict system of family pedigree (门第制度) was nevertheless formed during the Wei, Jin, and Northern and Southern Dynasties; various forms of usurpation or overstepping were unacceptable.

After the bureaucratic system was restored in the Tang Dynasty, "Shesheng" rapidly returned to Chinese society, and male wedding attire was, for the first time, explicitly linked with official robes. By the Song Dynasty, as the imperial examination system expanded, male weddings became further associated with passing the civil service exams. In fact, the term "*Xin Lang Guan*" originally referred exclusively to those who had successfully passed the exams.

During the Ming and Qing periods, the system of *Shesheng* in weddings fully matured and was oriented toward the entire society. Of course, within China's restoration-bureaucratic society, *Shesheng* did not only appear in weddings but permeated a vast array of ceremonial systems.

Now, readers can naturally discern the "indoctrinating" significance of the male wearing official robes and the female wearing a phoenix coronet and robes of rank (凤冠霞帔) during the wedding.

Through the wedding ceremony, the restoration-bureaucratic society—under the premise of absolute monarchical power—affirmed the power and status of the male patriarch within a patriarchal family (父权制家庭). Allowing the male to briefly don official robes during the wedding not only granted the individual an illusory sense of satisfaction but also forged a virtual relationship

of conferral and acceptance. Because an official's power ultimately originates from the emperor, he ought to remain loyal to the emperor under any condition.

Every time a wedding ceremony is performed, it consolidates the ideology of the **restoration-bureaucratic state** within society one more time, compelling people to subconsciously submit to reality.

By affirming the legitimacy of young, strong males acquiring power within the family, the restoration-bureaucratic system satisfied their vanity, while simultaneously guiding them to redirect the abuse they suffered from outsiders onto their own family members.

As for the wife, although she occupied a subordinate position relative to her husband, she could play the role of the master relative to the concubines. Simultaneously, female patriarchs wielded considerable despotic power over their children.

It is exactly through the prolonged domestication (驯化) of the people via various commonplace ceremonies that China's restoration-bureaucratic society established a rigorous hierarchical order and ideology, ultimately creating a **mutually-harming hell** (人人互害的地狱) where everyone preys upon everyone else.

Readers might not be able to profoundly empathize with this point, but for a Chinese person like me, who grew up in a typical Chinese-style family, these words are truly written in blood and tears (字字泣血).

One matter that evokes profound reflection in me is that Mao Zedong, the founder of the People's Republic of China, was actually a "**revolutionary pessimist**"—a reality starkly contrary to the perception of the vast majority.

On the mainland Chinese internet, the pro-establishment camp (建制派) often derides Chiang Kai-shek as the "Island Raider" (海岛奇兵), for he was undeniably the loser in the struggle for national state power.

However, in the more than two decades following 1949, it was precisely Chiang's opponent who repeatedly revealed the underlying thought: "*I will ultimately be crushed by the torrent of the times.*"

This is corroborated by his own *Selected Works*, his chronological biographies, his annotations on the *Zizhi Tongjian* (Comprehensive Mirror in Aid of Governance) and the *Twenty-Four Histories* (二十四史), as well as his commentaries on Chinese historical figures. A significant portion of these materials originates from the Institute of Party History and Literature of the CPC Central Committee and its predecessor departments; therefore, even the Chinese officialdom acknowledges this.

When commenting on Chinese history, Mao himself frequently adopted a "**Southern Dynasties-centric perspective**" (南朝本位). That is to say, he invariably utilized a specific historical analogy (比附), viewing himself as the *Jiangzuo* regimes (江左政权 / the regimes situated east of the Yangtze River) in Chinese history.

If one opens the records of his public evaluations of historical figures and his reading annotations, it becomes glaringly obvious that Mao harbored an extraordinary affinity for the six *Jiangzuo* regimes

—Eastern Wu, Eastern Jin, Liu Song, Southern Qi, Liang, and Chen—as well as the later Southern Song Dynasty.

Taking the Northern and Southern Dynasties period as an example, the currently verifiable number of Mao's evaluations and annotations regarding figures from the Southern Dynasties is nearly ten times that of figures from the Northern Dynasties. Within the *Twenty-Four Histories*, the volume of Mao's annotations on the *History of the Southern Dynasties* (《南史》) is second only to the *Records of the Three Kingdoms* (《三国志》) and the *Old and New Books of Tang* (新旧唐书), comparable to the *Records of the Grand Historian* (《史记》), and greater than the *Book of Han* (《汉书》) and the *Book of the Later Han* (《后汉书》).

Not only did he delight in evaluating figures from the Southern Dynasties, but his appraisals were significantly higher than the general consensus held by historical academia and the public.

Taking the Three Kingdoms period as an example, the general historical evaluation among the Chinese public places Shu Han above Cao Wei, and Cao Wei above Sun Wu (Eastern Wu). Out of his appreciation for Cao Cao's military strategy and literary talent, Mao substantially elevated his evaluation of Cao Wei. However, among the three kingdoms, his assessment diverged most drastically from general public opinion regarding Sun Wu.

Mao made no secret of his fondness for the *Jiangzuo* figures during the transition between the late Han and the Three Kingdoms. Sun Quan, Zhou Yu, Lu Su, Lu Xun, and even Lü Meng—who was disliked by the general public—all received exceptionally high praise from him.

Conversely, Guan Yu, who was killed by Eastern Wu, was given a very low evaluation by Mao. Even when discussing related historical figures, Mao never forgot to criticize Guan Yu's arrogance, pointing out that his elevated historical status was merely the beneficiary of the advocacy of the **feudal ethical code** (封建礼教). Regarding other historical figures of Shu Han, Mao's evaluations were also lower than the public average.

Following the founding of the state, he repeatedly demanded that leading cadres master a certain level of cultural knowledge. Lü Meng of Sun Wu and Cao Jingzong from the transition between Qi and Liang were established as typical models; additionally, Zhou Yu and Wei Rui were also regarded as exemplars for leading cadres to emulate.

Viewed in this light, Mao's attitude appears to be a bewildering anomaly (咄咄怪事). Why would this be the case? In fact, we can find the answer in his profound affection for the works of patriotic *Ci* (词) poets of the Southern Song Dynasty, represented by Xin Qiji and Chen Liang.

During the Southern Song period, because the Central Plains (中原) had already been occupied by the Jin Dynasty and the Song was in a diplomatically inferior position, patriotic intellectuals frequently analogized their current situation to the Northern and Southern Dynasties period. Through literary works, they extolled the monarchs and ministers who aggressively pushed for Northern Expeditions, while fiercely critiquing those who sought only a momentary, ignoble peace (苟求偏安).

When appreciating these Song *Ci* poems, **Mao engaged in an "analogy of an analogy" (比附之比附). He identified himself as the historical Southern Dynasties, mounting a helpless, desperate resistance against an unstoppable offensive from the North.**

This is precisely why Mao exhibited an extraordinary partiality for illustrious Southern Dynasties generals like Chen Qingzhi, while giving low appraisals to, or even completely ignoring, the outstanding military commanders and unifiers who campaigned in the North.

In truth, observing from the perspective of long-term historical evolution today, the abilities, morals, and achievements of the monarchs and ministers of both the North and the South were utterly mediocre (不过尔尔). After all, if Chinese history truly possessed so many heroic elites, how could it have degenerated to its current state?

Mao's personal historical worldview diverged drastically from widespread public opinion in some areas, yet aligned highly in others; the discrepancy frequently hinged entirely upon whether the historical figures served the *Jiangzuo* regimes.

Take Guan Yu and Yue Fei as examples. Both are historical figures who enjoy immense prestige among the populace, are beloved by the rulers of the **bureaucratic state** (官僚国家), have been heavily romanticized by literary works, and have had their military records significantly exaggerated.

While Mao manifestly disparaged Guan Yu on one hand, he simultaneously extolled Yue Fei in a fairly traditional manner on the other. When evaluating the biography of Du Mu in the *New Book of Tang*, he once again expounded on his view of Xiang Yu through Du Mu's poetry, affirming that Xiang Yu was an outstanding hero, and arguing that he should have retreated into Jiangdong (江东) to persist in the struggle rather than committing suicide.

It was precisely based on this historical analogy that Mao resonated so profoundly with Xin Qiji and Chen Liang, which likely influenced some of his foreign policies.

Since the Southern Dynasties were the side destined to be crushed by history, they should at least "*rely on the cross-flowing river and the continuous hills on three sides to strike a posture of contending for hegemony*" (一水横陈，三面连岗，做出争雄势). They needed to adopt the posture of a "Northern Expedition" (北伐) to increase buffer zones and delay the arrival of Doomsday.

In reality, the "export of revolution" (输出革命) and the international communist movements he fervently advocated were, to a large extent, a "Northern Expedition" based on exactly this mindset.

He absolutely did not genuinely believe that the situation was overwhelmingly excellent or that the "*East Wind had truly prevailed over the West Wind*." Rather, he was doing everything possible to maximize his bargaining chips (讨价还价的筹码) against his primary adversaries, particularly the United States.

The fact is, he indeed achieved his objective. Those left-wing students in Japan, France, and other countries—incited by fanatical emotions—were reduced to mere monkeys pulling chestnuts from the fire for someone else. Many of them were utterly dumbfounded and devastated when they heard of Nixon's visit to China.

By the mid-20th century, Taiwan had only been incorporated into China's territory for three centuries. According to China's traditional "worldview of All Under Heaven" (天下观), Mao had undoubtedly already acquired orthodox legitimacy (正统地位). Thus, when he analogized himself to the Southern Dynasties, he was evidently doing so on a global scale.

But did he view a specific imaginary enemy as the "Northern Dynasties"? If so, who exactly was this "Northern Dynasty"?

A universally recognized, successful conqueror of state power remained perpetually plagued by anxiety and dread (惶惶不安), believing that his enterprise would ultimately come to nothing. This was not a phenomenon that merely emerged in the final decade of his life; such tendencies were already present at least as early as the Xibaipo period. How can this be considered anything but a tragicomedy of history?

As for the image of the heroic figure brimming with "revolutionary optimism" in our country's official discourse, there is almost no need for refutation.

Because the official justifications often rely on certain poems and lyric verses (诗词歌赋). However, anyone with basic cultural literacy knows that a literary genre like poetry can absolutely not serve as the basis for judging an author's worldview and long-term emotional disposition.

Obviously, a poet of the Graceful and Restrained school (婉约派) can compose verses more heroic than those of the Heroic and Abandoned school (豪放派), and an acknowledged poet of the Heroic school can likewise produce works more delicate than those of the Graceful school. Anyone who has undergone compulsory education knows this.

Compared to genres like poetry, which express short-term emotional impulses, full-length novels and epic narrative poems can accurately reflect the author's actual worldview and historical perspective. I believe it is impossible for anyone who has read a certain amount of literature not to understand this principle.

On today's internet, using a few pages from a historical figure's diary or one or two poems to adjudge that figure's political inclinations and fundamental views of the world is a quintessential logical fallacy.

7, 中国统治者掌握了说谎的要领

这一小节的标题似乎和上上个小节非常矛盾, 如果中国统治者真的掌握了说谎的要领, 那么为什么他们编造的谎言还拙劣呢? 这样一组看似矛盾的事实恰恰反映了“说谎”作为一种政治行为应当如何进行。除了省略, 使用遁词在真话中掺杂假话这种常见的说谎方法以外, 我们特别需要注意的一个关键点是, 群体心理学跟个体心理学是具有差别的。因此纳粹的宣传部长戈培尔就非常强调一点, 如果(政府)要撒谎, 那就一定要说弥天大谎而非小的谎言。对于个人来说, 一个离奇的谎言反而会让人觉得它“不太可能是假的”。人们倾向于认为, 没有人会大胆的编造如此荒谬的谎言。好比汉高祖刘邦明明身无分文, 却敢于称自己“贺钱万”, 这个数目实在是太大了, 以至于人们下意识地不会认为有人敢开这样的玩笑。

一旦政府将这种技巧运用到社会中, 那么谎言的效应就会放大。统治者以权威人物或者机构来发布谎言, 这在一开始就会在缺乏证据时欺骗一小批盲信者。因为潜意识里也认定这个谎言离谱, 一旦人们相信了它, 就会倾向于寻找支持该谎言的信息, 而忽略或否定与之矛盾的信息, 这也就是人们常说的“确认偏误”。在自己完成信念上的强化之后, 相信谎言的人会试着说服周围的人, 以缓解自己潜意识里的怀疑所带来的焦虑。一旦很多人都相信某个谎言, 那么个体可能会迫于社会压力而选择相信, 即使自己内心仍然有所疑虑。人们在公开表示相信某个谎言之后, 出于维护自身形象, 也就是中国人常说的面子的考虑, 即使后来得知真相, 也不愿意承认自己被骗。

丹麦童话作家安徒生所写的名篇《皇帝的新衣》讲的就是这样一个事。人人都觉得一个高高在上的, 风光无限的国王不可能愚蠢到看不出来自己没有穿衣服, 因此人人争相夸赞一件本就不存在的衣服漂亮。

在最后戳破了这个谎言的却是一个儿童，因为孩子是无所谓什么脸面的，他还没有到具有面子这种自我认识的年龄。中国的历史直接用一个现实的，如此长久和广泛的例子证明了安徒生先生的伟大，事实就是，这样的童话完全可以发生到现实中，而且所涉及的文明在历史时期占了全世界人口和经济总量的四分之一左右。中华帝国是怎么如此持久地欺骗自己的臣民和国外的观察者呢？无非就是它的历史太悠久，体量太巨大，再稍微装扮一下，如果我们不加解释地对一个外邦人说：这个所谓的天朝上国其实早就是行尸走肉了。那么这个外邦人也很难相信。每当中国官方及其意识形态所持的观点过于离奇的时候，人们反而会思考这是不是真的。一个看起来如此强大并且在历史上素有威望的国家会进行这样的欺骗吗？这种想法就和《皇帝的新装》中国王的臣民看待作为裸男的国王时的心理是一样的。如果不去说弥天大谎而是说一般的谎言，那么被人识破的概率可能更高。因为在人的一生中几乎很难避免说谎，大部分人对于小的谎言是很熟悉的。人们对于自己比较了解的事物能够有很好的直觉，戈培尔所谓的撒弥天大谎在一定程度上就是要先声夺人，破坏民众的理性思考。

说谎的第二个诀窍在于永远不要试图圆谎，在面对整个社会说谎的时候尤其如此。任何谎言，无论其大小和恶劣程度，本质上都是一种与现实相悖的叙事。我们从抽象的角度说，按照物理学的观点，一个系统的完整信息即使在经历了复杂变化后，仍然以某种形式存在于宇宙。因此谎言是圆不回来的，而且掩盖谎言需要更多的谎言，这样破绽只能越来越多。同时说谎的时候如果已经在想着怎么圆谎，那么说谎的人就很难在气势上压倒听众。《商君书》在两千年前就敏锐地指出了这一点，朝廷没有千日做贼的道理，统治者不能成为窃国的贼和骗子，而要直接成为暴徒。他需要做的事情不是客客气气地骗取人民的信任，而是直接强奸人民的思想；不是把人民诱导到自己的陷阱中，而是直接绑架到贼船上。因此说谎的时候就不要考虑后果，统治者应该做的事情就是让这个谎言足够大，足够支撑一次性干一大票坏事，而不是想着接下来怎么骗。只要通过一次决定性的欺骗实现了自己的政治目的，那么让那些上当的人无论出于什么原因都没有办法再反悔就好了。

二次大战中的纳粹德国和日本帝国就是非常好的例子，直到盟军攻入德国本土，纳粹政权还在通过军事法庭处决逃兵；即使在遭受原子弹轰炸的前几天，日本人还在准备“一亿玉碎”。德国和日本一亿多老百姓怎么可能全是傻瓜，哪怕战报里歼灭了多少敌人的人员和装备，战火烧到自己本土难道还能不知道吗？从天而降的炸弹能是假的吗？但是到这个时候德国和日本百姓就是知道自己上了当也没办法了。统治者在做坏事的时候的确就是冲着这种目的来的，人民最开始发现自己被政府欺骗可能只是出于社会舆论的压力和顾及自己的脸面而不愿承认。等到他们已经完全没办法再欺骗自己的时候，就发现自己已经跳不了船了，现在整个国家和民族都要为统治者以及他所倚仗的邪恶制度陪葬。

这样读者就能够大致理解为什么我既说中国统治者掌握了说谎的要领，又说他们的谎言往往极其拙劣，这非但不矛盾，反而合乎逻辑。正是因为中国统治者在历史上已经通过惊人的对于历史叙事的扭曲几乎完全欺骗住了国内外人民和学者，所以他们现在才可以通过仅仅用低成本的，极其拙劣的谎言就能够维持其统治，这是一件非常悲哀的事情。如果读者仍然觉得难以置信，那么只需继续看下去，等到看完整份文稿心中自然也就了然了。

在这一小节最后我也要指出，复辟官僚国家编造历史谎言的行为虽然有的时候非常拙劣，但是它在“教化”民众上的确是很有本事的。读者如果关注中国的社会舆论就会知道最近几年中国各地兴起了汉服热，这也同时带动了以汉族传统服饰为主要特征的汉族传统婚礼受到追捧。读者马上就能够意识到，婚礼作为人生中的重要仪式在复辟官僚国家晚期已经成为了灌输复辟官僚社会意识形态的一个重要场合。例如在全世界的所有主要文明中，只有中国人把新郎叫做“新郎官”。外国人几乎很难想象，结婚就结婚，跟当不当官有什么关系。但是在官僚系统完全决定权利和社会资源分配的地方，升官几乎就是一个人能够给出的最好的祝福，再要不然就是祝别人当皇帝这样“大逆不道”的言论了。汉族传统婚服充分反映了这种意识形态，到明代为止，只要有条件新郎会身着官服作为婚服，新娘则可以使用诰命的礼制。

然而很显然，汉族的传统婚服在一开始并非如此，婚服的变化恰恰反映了中国历史进程的演进。在秦汉时期的古典中国，婚礼时的服装和新人的发型应该如何处理这样的问题仅仅是为了表明一点，那就是夫妻双方都已经成年，并且完全有能力肩负起组建家庭的责任。在东汉时期，因为官僚制度已经变得十分强力，东汉经学家郑玄在给《仪礼》作注时首先提出了“摄盛”这一概念，即夫妻双方在结婚时可以采取稍有“僭越”的礼制，但是这里的礼制反映的就是官僚等级了。东汉经学在“通三统”的时候历来采取这样惯用的招数，那就是把先秦时期早期国家的贵族等级制度与西汉中期以后的官僚等级制度划

等号，进而在一些概念上偷梁换柱。东汉经学家当然很清楚先秦社会跟他们现在所处的时代有多么大的不同，但是官僚体制对社会越来越强的主导作用使这种适应性的“再解释运动”必然会发生。

在公元三到六世纪，中国封建化程度最高的时期，“摄盛”遭到了抑制。这有一定必然性，虽然地主阶级没有成功转化为封建领主，但是在魏晋南北朝时期毕竟形成了严格的门第制度，各种形式的僭越是被接受的。唐代官僚制度复辟之后，“摄盛”迅速回归中国社会，男性婚服第一次与官服相挂钩。等到宋代科举制度扩大，男性结婚又进一步与科举及第相联系，实际上新郎官最早也指的是科举登第者。明清时期婚礼中的摄盛制度就完全成熟并且面向社会了。当然摄盛在中国复辟官僚社会中不止出现在婚礼上，而是广泛出现在各种各样的礼制里。

现在读者自然能看出在婚礼中男性穿官服，女性着凤冠霞帔的“教化”意义。通过婚礼仪式，复辟官僚社会在以君主绝对权力作为主导的前提下，肯定了男性家长在父权制家庭中的权力和地位。让男性在婚礼时短暂身着官服，不仅仅是使当事人产生一种虚幻的满足感，同时也形成了一种虚拟的授受关系。因为官员的权力既然最终来源于皇帝，那么他就应该在任何条件下都效忠皇帝。婚礼仪式每进行一次，就在社会巩固了一次复辟官僚国家的意识形态，使得人们不自觉地屈服于现实。复辟官僚体制通过肯定年富力强的男性在家庭中获得权力的正当性满足了他们的虚荣心，同时也引导他们将在外人面前遭受的虐待转而施加到自己家人身上。对于妻子而言，虽然她相对于丈夫也处于弱势地位，但是相对于其他妾来说又可以扮演主子的角色，同时女性家长对于子女也有相当的专制权力。中国的复辟官僚社会就是通过各种各样常见仪式对于人民的持久驯化，建立起了一套严密的等级秩序和意识形态，并且最终创造了一个人人互害的地狱。读者不一定能深刻体会到一点，但是对于像我这样在典型的中国式家庭中成长起来的中国人而言，这些话可以说是字字泣血了。

有一件令我感触颇深的事情是，中华人民共和国的缔造者毛泽东就是一位“革命悲观主义者”，这与大部分人的认识截然相反。在大陆的中文互联网上，建制派往往讥讽蒋介石为“海岛奇兵”，因为他无疑是全国政权争夺中的失败者。然而，在1949年之后二十余年间屡次流露出“我终将被时代的洪流碾碎”这样想法的恰恰是蒋的对手。这一点为他本人的选集，年表，对《资治通鉴》和二十四史的批注，对中国历史人物的点评做证明，这些资料中相当多都出自中央党史和文献研究院及其前身部门，因此即便是中国官方也是承认的。毛本人在对中国历史进行评论的时候常常采取一种“南朝本位”的观点，也就是说，他总是采取这样一种比附，将自己视为中国历史上的江左政权。如果人们翻开他对于历史人物在公开场合的评价记录和阅读批注，就可以很明显地发现毛对于东吴、东晋、宋、齐、梁、陈这六个江左政权，以及更晚的南宋有一种异乎寻常的亲近感。以南北朝时期为例，毛对于南朝一方人物现今可查的评价和批注数量是北朝一方人物的近十倍。在二十四史中，毛对《南史》的批注数量仅次于《三国志》和新旧唐书，与《史记》相当，多于《汉书》和《后汉书》。他不但喜爱评价南朝人物，而且相较于历史学界以及民间的一般认识要明显高出许多。以三国时期为例，中国民间的历史评价大致是蜀汉高于曹魏高于孙吴，毛出于对于曹操武略文采的认可大幅提高了曹魏的评价，但是在三国之中他的评价与民间一般看法差异最大的是孙吴。毛对于汉末三国之际的江左人物毫不掩饰其喜爱，孙权、周瑜、鲁肃、陆逊以及被民间所不喜的吕蒙都得到了他的极高评价。相反，被东吴所杀的关羽则被其给予了很低的评价，甚至在谈及有关历史人物时也不忘批评关羽的傲慢，并指其历史地位得益于封建礼教的鼓吹。对于蜀汉的其他历史人物，毛的评价也要低于民间的平均水平。在建国之后，他屡次要求领导干部要掌握一定文化知识，孙吴的吕蒙和齐梁之际的曹景宗是树立的典型，另外周瑜和韦睿也被视作领导干部学习的榜样。

这样看来，毛的态度真是咄咄怪事，为什么会这样呢？其实我们可以从他对于以辛弃疾和陈亮为代表的南宋爱国词人作品的喜爱上得到答案。南宋时期，由于中原已被金朝所占据并且宋在外交上属于弱势地位，爱国知识分子常常把当下形势和南北朝时期进行比附，用文学作品歌颂北伐进取的君臣而批判那些苟求偏安者。毛在鉴赏这些宋词的时候便进行了比附之比附，他将自己认作历史上的南朝，要对北方不可阻挡的进攻进行无可奈何的抵抗。这就是为什么毛会异乎寻常的偏爱陈庆之这样的南朝名将，但是对于在北方征战的杰出军事将领和统一者们评价不高乃至忽视。其实在我现在从历史长期演变过程看来，南北两方君臣的能力、道德和功业均不过尔尔，毕竟如果中国历史上真有那么英雄豪杰，又何以沦落至此呢？毛本人的历史观与民间的普遍观点在有的地方差异很大，在有的地方有高度一致，里面的差距经常就出现在历史人物是否服务于江左政权。以关羽和岳飞为例，他们都是在民间享有盛誉的，为官僚国家统治者所喜爱的，被文学作品进行过美化的，战绩被明显夸大的历史人物。毛一方面对关羽进

行明显的贬低，另一方面却又按照相当传统的方式颂扬岳飞。在对《新唐书》的杜牧传进行评价的时候，他又从杜牧的诗中再次阐释了对项羽的看法，肯定了项羽是一个杰出的英雄，并且认为他应该退入江东坚持斗争而不是自杀。

正是基于这种比附，毛对于辛弃疾和陈亮产生了极大共鸣，并且可能影响到了他的一些对外政策。既然南朝是注定要被历史碾碎的一方，那么至少应当“一水横陈，三面连岗，做出争雄势”，以北伐的姿态增加缓冲区并延缓末日的到来。实际上，他所鼓吹的输出革命与国际共产主义运动，很大程度上就是基于这样一种观点的“北伐”。他绝不是认为形势真的一片大好，东风的确压倒了西风，而是尽可能的增加与主要对手，尤其是美国之间讨价还价的筹码。事实就是，他的确达到了目的，那些被狂热情绪所煽动的日本、法国以及其他国家的左翼学生沦为了为他人火中取栗的猴子，许多人听到尼克松访华的时候震惊不已。在上个世纪中叶，台湾被纳入中国版图不过三世纪，按照中国传统的“天下观”，毛无疑已经取得正统地位。他将自己比附为南朝，显然是以全世界范围来说的，但是他是否把某个假想敌视作北朝呢，如果有，那这个“北朝”是谁？一个公认的夺取政权的成功者却始终惶惶不安，认为自己的事业终究是一场空，这并非他人生最后十年才出现的事，至少在西柏坡时期就已经有这样的倾向，如何不是一出历史的悲喜剧呢。

至于我国官方语境中的那个充满着革命乐观主义的英雄人物形象，则几乎没有反驳的必要。因为官方的依据往往是一些诗词歌赋，但是任何一个有基本文化素养的人都知道，像诗歌这种文体决然无法作为判断作者世界观和长期的情感倾向的依据，显然一个婉约派的词人可以写出比豪放派还豪放的词，一个公认的豪放派词人也可以写出比婉约派还婉约的作品，只要受过义务教育都知道这一点。与诗歌这样表现短期的情感冲动的体裁相比，长篇小说和长篇叙事诗则能够准确的反映作者本人的世界观和历史观，我认为只要读过一定的文学作品的人都不可能不懂这个道理。在当今互联网中，拿历史人物日记的其中几页以及一两首诗歌就去判定该历史人物的政治倾向以及对于世界的一些基本观点属于非常经典的逻辑谬误。